

Fit & Well:

Core Concepts and Labs in Physical Fitness and Wellness

15th Edition
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1: Introduction to Wellness, Fitness, and Lifestyle Management

Looking Ahead...

After reading this chapter, you should be able to:

- Describe the dimensions of wellness.
- Identify the major health and lifestyle problems in the United States today.
- Describe the behaviors that are part of a wellness lifestyle.
- Evaluate some of the available sources of wellness information.
- Create a behavior management plan.

Wellness: New Health Goals

Healthy people seek a state of overall wellness rather than merely the absence of illness.

- **Health:** the overall condition of body or mind and the presence or absence of illness or injury.
- **Wellness:** optimal health and vitality, encompassing all dimensions of well-being.
- **Risk factor:** a condition that increases one's chances of disease or injury.

The Dimensions of Wellness ¹

Nine dimensions contribute to overall wellness:

- Physical.
- Emotional.
- Intellectual.
- Interpersonal.
- Cultural.
- Spiritual.
- Environmental.
- Financial.
- Occupational.



The Dimensions of Wellness ²

Physical wellness includes your fitness level and your ability to care for yourself.

Emotional wellness reflects your ability to understand and deal with your feelings.

Intellectual wellness involves active, curious minds that are able to detect problems and seek solutions to questions about themselves and the larger world.

- People who enjoy intellectual wellness never stop learning.

The Dimensions of Wellness ³

Interpersonal wellness includes the ability to develop and maintain satisfying and supportive relationships.

Cultural wellness refers to the way you interact with others who are different from you and includes accepting, valuing, and celebrating different cultural ways.

Spiritual wellness involves the guiding beliefs, principles, or values that give meaning and purpose to your life.

- It may be based in an organized religion or not.

The Dimensions of Wellness ⁴

Environmental wellness is defined by the livability of your surroundings, including the health of the planet.

Financial wellness is the ability to live within your means and manage your money in a way that gives you peace of mind.

Occupational wellness is the level of happiness and fulfillment you gain through your work.



Figure 1.1 Qualities and behaviors associated with the dimensions of wellness

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New Opportunities for Taking Charge ¹

Life expectancy has roughly doubled since 1850.

In 1850, infectious disease and poor environmental conditions shortened many lives.

- A person could expect to live only about 38–40 years.

The rate of improvement has slowed and, in some recent years, actually declined—even without factoring in the COVID-19 pandemic.

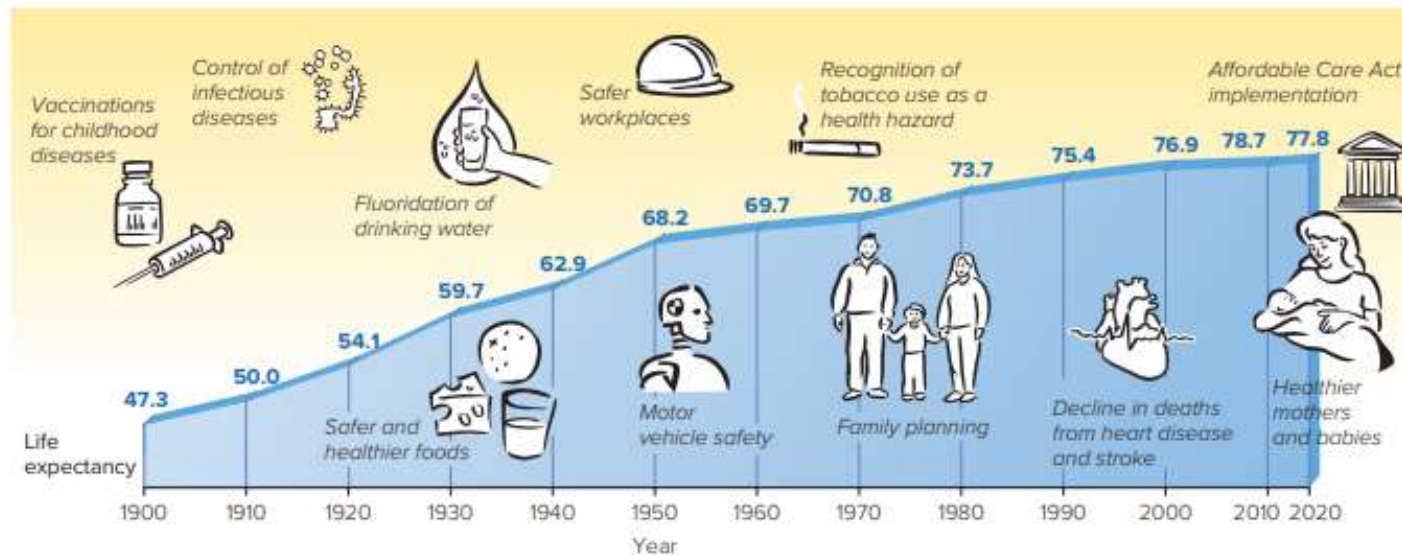


Figure 1.2 Public health and life expectancy of Americans from birth

Public health achievements during the 20th and 21st centuries are credited with adding more than 25 years to life expectancy for Americans, greatly improving quality of life, and dramatically reducing deaths from infectious diseases. Recent public health improvements include greater roadway safety, a steep decline in childhood lead poisoning, and an expansion of health insurance coverage. The decline in life expectancy in 2020, especially for Black and Hispanic people, was attributed primarily to the COVID-19 pandemic, which became the third-leading cause of death that year; but the opioid and obesity epidemics were also responsible for recent life expectancy declines.

[Access the text alternative for slide images.](#)

Sources: Arias, E., B. Tejada-Vera, and F. Ahmad. 2021. Provisional life expectancy estimates for January through June, 2020. *Vital Statistics Rapid Release*, No. 10. Hyattsville, MD: National Center for Health Statistics. <https://dx.doi.org/10.15620/cdc:100392>; Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. 1999. Ten great public health achievements—United States, 1900–1999. *MMWR* 48(50): 1141.

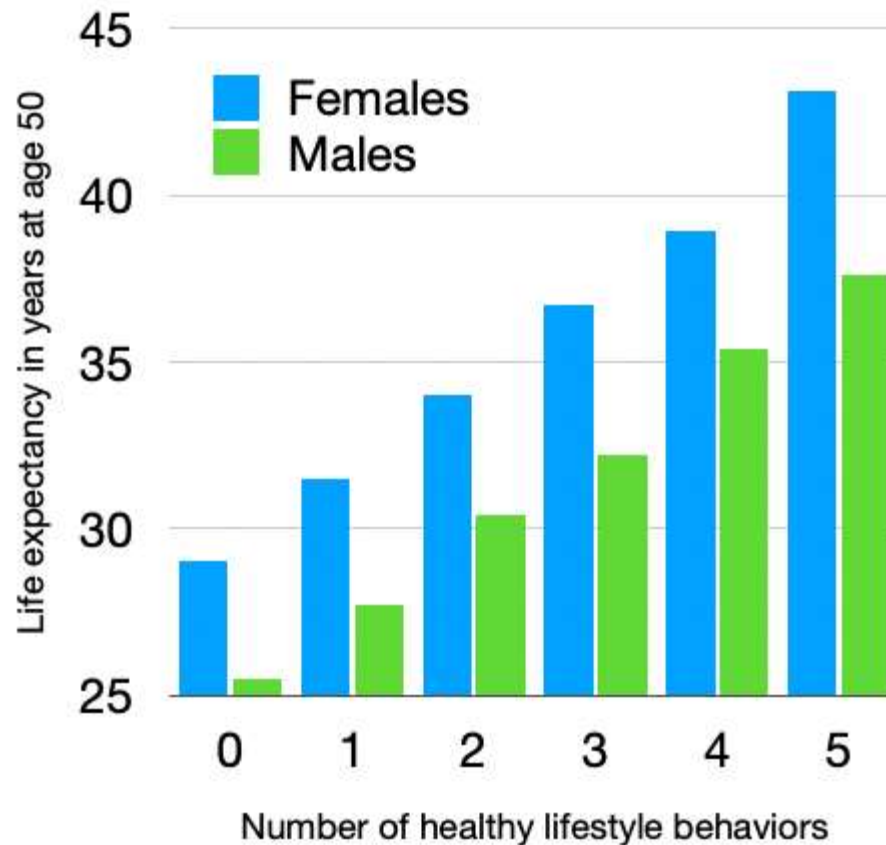


Figure 1.3 Life expectancy and healthy habits

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New Opportunities for Taking Charge ²

Today, a different set of diseases has emerged as our major health threat:

- Heart disease.
- Cancer.
- Other chronic diseases, especially those linked to obesity and poor eating habits that began in the late 1970s.

Chronic disease: those that develop and continue over a long period of time.

Lifestyle choices: conscious behaviors that can increase or decrease a person's risk of disease or injury.

- Examples: never smoking, getting regular physical

Table 1.1 Leading Causes of Death in the United States, 2020

RANK	CAUSE OF DEATH	NUMBER OF DEATHS	PERCENTAGE OF TOTAL DEATHS	LIFESTYLE FACTORS
1	Heart disease	690,882	20.6%	Diet, inactive lifestyle, smoking, excessive alcohol use, obesity
2	Cancer	598,932	17.8%	Diet, inactive lifestyle, smoking, excessive alcohol use, obesity
3	COVID-19	345,323	10.2%	Diet, Inactive lifestyle, smoking, excessive alcohol use, obesity
4	Unintentional injuries	192,175	5.7%	Inactive lifestyle, smoking, excessive alcohol use
5	Stroke	159,050	4.7%	Diet, inactive lifestyle, smoking, excessive alcohol use, obesity
6	Chronic lower respiratory diseases	151,637	4.5%	Diet, inactive lifestyle, smoking, obesity
7	Alzheimer disease	133,382	4.0%	Inactive lifestyle, smoking
8	Diabetes mellitus	101,106	3.0%	Diet, inactive lifestyle, smoking, excessive alcohol use, obesity
9	Influenza and pneumonia	53,495	1.6%	Smoking, excessive alcohol use
10	Kidney disease	52,260	1.6%	Smoking, excessive alcohol use, obesity
All	All causes	3,358,814	100.0%	All

Note: Although not among the overall top 10 causes of death, HIV/AIDS (5,044 deaths in 2019) is a major killer. In 2019, HIV/AIDS was the tenth-leading cause of death for Americans aged 25–34 years.

Source: Ahmad, F. B., et al. 2021. The leading causes of death in the US for 2020, *JAMA* (Doi:10.1001/jama.2021.5469); Xu, J.Q., et al. 2021. Deaths: Final data for 2019. *National Vital Statistics Reports*, vol. 70, no. 8. Hyattsville, MD: National Center for Health Statistics. <https://dx.doi.org/10.15620/cdc:106058>; Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. 2020. *COVID-19: Assessing Risk Factors* (<https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/covid-data/investigations-discovery/assessing-risk-factors.html>).

Table 1.2 Leading Causes of Death among Americans Aged 15–24, 2019

RANK	CAUSE OF DEATH	NUMBER OF DEATHS	PERCENTAGE OF TOTAL DEATHS
1	Unintentional injuries	11,755	39.5%
1a	Unintentional injuries: motor vehicle	5,867	19.7%
1b	Unintentional injuries: poisoning*	4,346	14.6%
2	Suicide	5,954	20.0%
3	Homicide	4,774	16.0%
4	Cancer	1,388	4.7%
5	Heart disease	872	2.9%
All	All causes	29,767	100.0%

*Poisoning deaths in this age group are primarily due to drug and alcohol overdose.

Source: Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. 2021. 10 leading causes of death by age group, United States, 2019. Web-Based Injury Statistics Query and Reporting System (www.cdc.gov/injury/wisqars).

New Opportunities for Taking Charge ³

Lifestyle factors impact both quantity and quality of life. The major difference between **life span** (how long we live) and **health span** (how long we stay healthy) is freedom from chronic or disabling disease.

One lifestyle behavior—exercise—varies among people in different income and education groups and in different parts of the country.

How do external factors influence your own health habits?

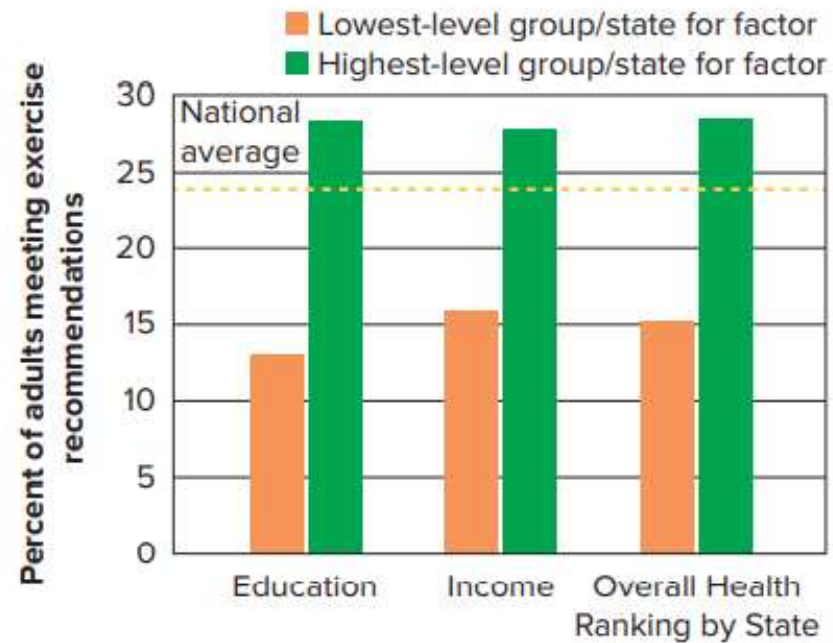


Figure 1.4 Differences in rates of exercise associated with social environmental factors

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Sources: United Health Foundation. 2020. *America's Health Rankings Annual Report, 2020* (www.americashealthrankings.org/learn/reports/2020-annual-report); U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. 2020. *Healthy People 2020: An End of Decade Snapshot* (<https://health.gov/our-work/healthy-people/assessing-healthy-people-2020>).

National Health

Wellness is a personal concern, but the U.S. government has financial and humanitarian interests in it too.

- A healthy population is the nation's source of vitality, creativity, and wealth.
- Poor health drains the nation's resources and raises health care costs for all.

Health Insurance Options ¹

The Affordable Care Act (ACA) was signed into law in 2010.

- Although it remains in effect, certain provisions have been altered—and insurance costs will likely increase as a result.

Finding a health insurance plan:

- The ACA established health exchanges to facilitate purchase of insurance; those below income requirements are eligible for federal help with premiums.
- Often insurance plans are available from employers, universities, and professional groups.

Health Insurance Options ₂

Benefits to college students:

- Under the ACA, young adults can stay on their parents' health insurance plans until age 26.
- Students who are young and healthy and who are purchasing health insurance may be tempted by a “catastrophic” plan—but this type of plan does not cover many important types of care.
- Students whose income is below a certain level may qualify for Medicaid.

The *Healthy People* Initiative

Continuing a trend set by the national *Healthy People 2020*, *Healthy People 2030* proposes these objectives:

- Attain healthy, thriving lives and well-being free of preventable disease, disability, injury, and premature death.
- Eliminate health disparities, achieve health equity, and attain health literacy to improve the health and well-being of all.
- Create social, physical, and economic environments that promote attaining the full potential for health and well-being for all.
- Promote healthy development, healthy behaviors, and well-being across all life stages.

Table 1.3 Progress toward *Healthy People* Targets

OBJECTIVE	BASELINE (% MEETING GOAL IN 2008)	MOST RECENT PROGRESS (% MEETING GOAL IN 2016–2018)	TARGET (% BY 2030)
Increase proportion of people with health insurance	83.2%	89.0%	92.1%
Reduce proportion of adults with hypertension	29.9%	29.5%	27.7%
Reduce proportion of adults who are obese	33.9%	38.6%	36%
Reduce proportion of adults who engaged in binge drinking in past 30 days	28.2%	26.6%	25.4%
Increase proportion of adults who meet federal guidelines for exercise	18.2%	24.0%	28.4%
Reduce proportion of adults who smoke cigarettes	20.6%	13.9%	5.0%

Source: U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. Healthy People 2020 data search (www.healthypeople.gov/2020/data-search/Search-the-Data). U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. Healthy People 2030 (<https://health.gov/healthypeople>).

Behaviors That Contribute to Wellness ¹

Be physically active.

- **Physical fitness:** a set of physical attributes that allow the body to respond or adapt to the demands and stress of physical effort.
- **Sedentary:** physically inactive; literally, “sitting.”



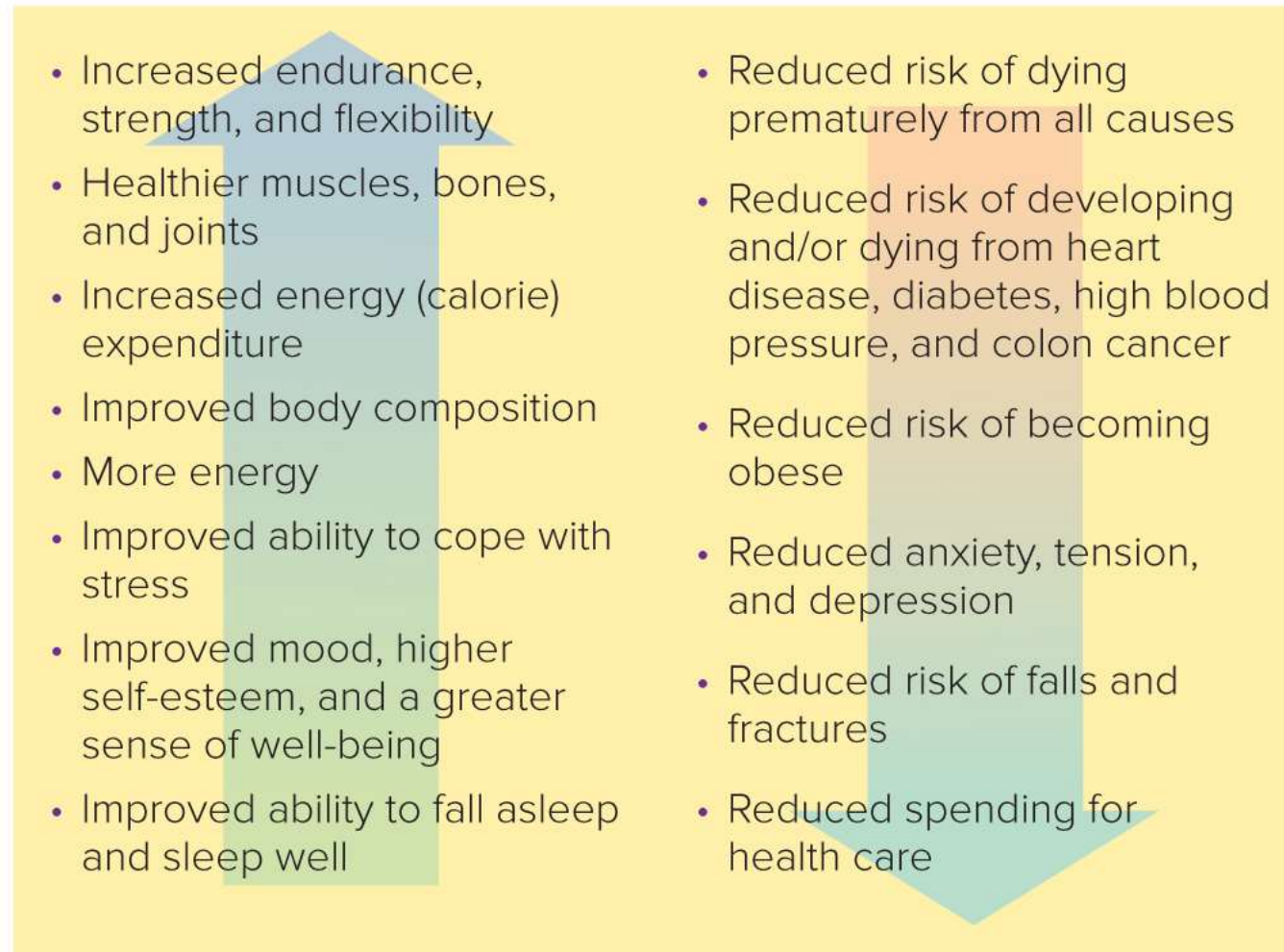


Figure 1.5 Benefits of regular physical activity

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Behaviors That Contribute to Wellness ²

In addition to being physically active:

- Choose a healthy diet.
- Maintain a healthy body weight.
- Manage stress effectively.
- Avoid tobacco and drug use and limit alcohol consumption.
- Protect yourself from disease and injury.

Behaviors That Contribute to Wellness ³

Take other steps toward wellness:

- Develop meaningful relationships.
- Plan for successful aging.
- Learn about the health care system.
- Act responsibly toward the environment.

Wellness Factors That Seem Outside Our Control

Heredity, the environment, and adequate health care are other important influences that interact.

- For example, a sedentary lifestyle combined with a genetic predisposition for diabetes and lacking adequate health care.

Behavior can tip balance toward health.

College Students and Wellness

It is common for students to lose productive academic time to activities causing stress and other physical and emotional health problems.

By reducing unhealthy choices and increasing healthy choices—such as by improving their time management, diet, and exercise—students can improve their wellness.

Reaching Wellness through Lifestyle Management

Moving toward wellness means cultivating healthy behaviors and working to overcome unhealthy ones.

Behavior change: a lifestyle management process that involves cultivating healthy behaviors and working to overcome unhealthy ones.



Getting Serious about Your Health ¹

Before you can change, you must know that the behavior is a problem and that you can change it.

Examine your current health habits:

- Think about your behavior.
- Talk with friends and family members.
- Digital trackers can help.

Getting Serious about Your Health ²

Choose a target behavior.

- **Target behavior:** an isolated behavior selected as the object of a behavior change program.
- Your chances of success are greater if your first goal is simple.
- Build on your success over time.

Learn about your target behavior.

- Assess how the target behavior affects your level of wellness.

Find help.

Building Motivation to Change ¹

Examine the pros and cons of change.

- Health behaviors have both short-term and long-term benefits and costs.
- To be successful, you must believe that the benefits of change outweigh the costs.
- Most people are more likely to be motivated by shorter-term goals.
- Over time, small differences can add up.

Building Motivation to Change ²

Boost self-efficacy.

- **Self-efficacy:** the belief in one's ability to take action and perform a specific task.
- **Locus of control:** the figurative “place” people designate as the source of responsibility for events in their life.
- Visualize yourself enjoying the benefits of change.
- **Self-talk:** a person's internal dialogue.
- Role models and other supportive individuals can make a big difference in your level of motivation and chances of success.

Building Motivation to Change ³

Identify and overcome barriers to change.

- Don't let past failures discourage you; they can be a great source of information you can use.
- List the key barriers to change: the problems and challenges you faced; and the short-term costs.
- Develop a practical plan for overcoming each barrier.

Enhancing Your Readiness to Change

The transtheoretical, or “stages-of-change,” model is an effective approach to lifestyle self-management.

- Precontemplation: no intention of changing behavior.
- Contemplation: intends to take action within six months.
- Preparation: plans to take action within a month.
- Action: outwardly changes behavior and environment.
- Maintenance: successful behavior change is maintained for six months or more.
- Termination: has exited the cycle of change and is no longer tempted to lapse into old behavior.

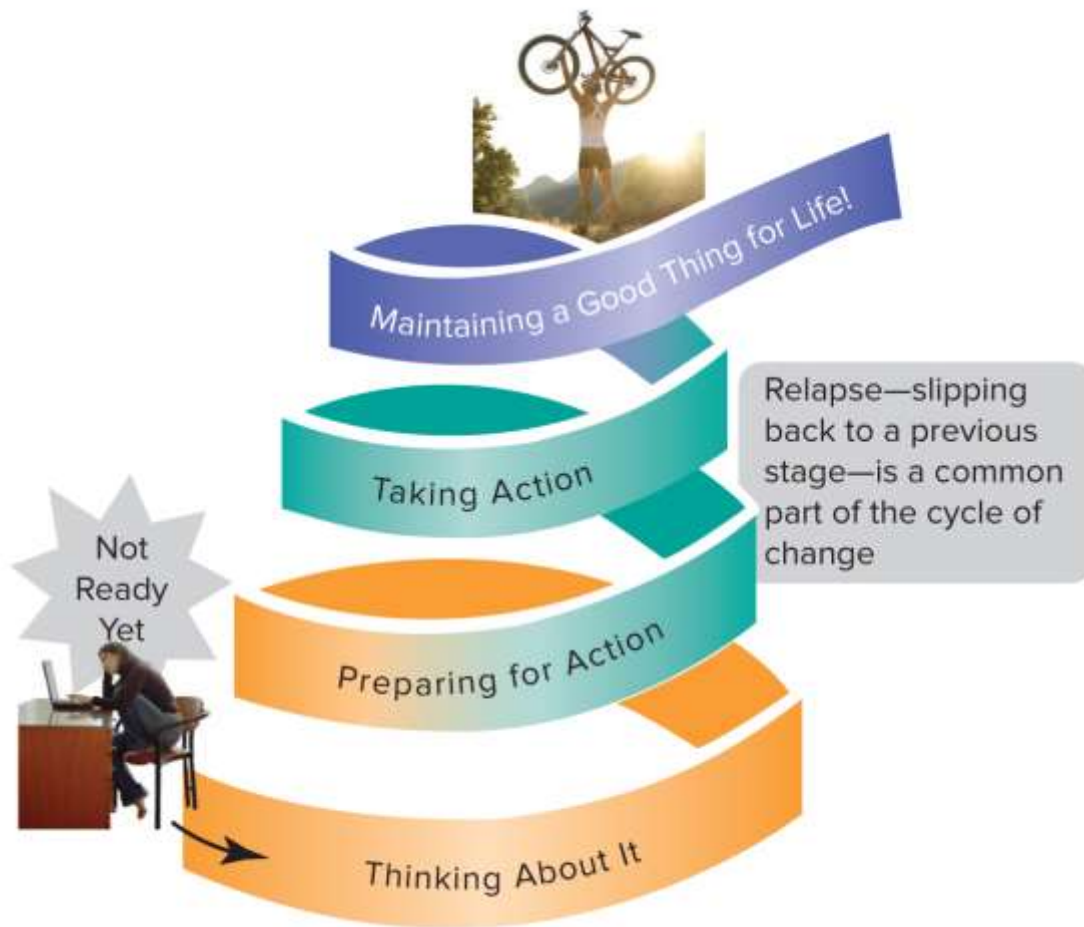


Figure 1.6 The stages of change: A spiral model

[Access the text alternative for slide images.](#)

Source: Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (n.d.). *PEP Guide: Personal Empowerment Plan for Improving Eating and Increasing Physical Activity*. Dallas, TX: The Cooper Institute. (bike): Adam Brown/UpperCut Images/Getty Images; (desk): Ray Kachatorian/ The Image Bank/Getty Images

Dealing with Relapse

People seldom progress through the stages of change in a linear way.

Most people make several attempts before they successfully change their behavior.

If relapse occurs:

- Forgive yourself.
- Give yourself credit for progress.
- Move on.

Developing Skills for Change: Creating a Personalized Plan ¹

Monitor your behavior and gather data.

- What the activity was.
- When and where it happened.
- What you were doing.
- How you felt at that time.

Analyze the data and identify patterns.

Developing Skills for Change: Creating a Personalized Plan ₂

Be “SMART” about setting goals, making them:

- Specific.
- Measurable.
- Attainable.
- Realistic.
- Time frame—specific.

Developing Skills for Change: Creating a Personalized Plan ³

Devise a plan of action.

- Get what you need.
- Modify your environment.
- Control related habits.
- Reward yourself.
- Involve the people around you.
- Plan for challenges.

Developing Skills for Change: Creating a Personalized Plan ⁴

Make a personal contract that includes:

- A statement of your goal and your commitment to reaching it.
- The date you will start.
- The steps you will take to measure your progress.
- The date you expect to reach your final goal.

Date <u>November 5</u> Day M TU W TH F SA SU										
<i>Time of day</i>	<i>M/S</i>	<i>Food eaten</i>	<i>Cals.</i>	<i>H</i>	<i>Where did you eat?</i>	<i>What else were you doing?</i>	<i>How did someone else influence you?</i>	<i>What made you want to eat what you did?</i>	<i>Emotions and feelings?</i>	<i>Thoughts and concerns?</i>
7:30	M	1 C Crispix cereal 1/2 C skim milk coffee, black 1 C orange juice	110 40 — 120	3	home	looking at news headlines on my phone	alone	I always eat cereal in the morning	a little keyed up & worried	thinking about quiz in class today
10:30	S	1 apple	90	1	hall outside classroom	studying	alone	felt tired & wanted to wake up	tired	worried about next class
12:30	M	1 C chili 1 roll 1 pat butter 1 orange 2 oatmeal cookies 1 soda	290 120 35 60 120 150	2	campus food court	talking	eating w/ friends; we decided to eat at the food court	wanted to be part of group	excited & happy	interested in hearing everyone's plans for the weekend
M/S = Meal or snack H = Hunger rating (0–3)										

Figure 1.7 Sample health journal entries

[Access the text alternative for slide images.](#)

Behavior Change Contract

- I, Tammy Lau, agree to
increase my consumption of fruit from 1 cup per week to 2 cups per day.
- I will begin on 10/5 and plan to reach my goal of
2 cups of fruit per day by 12/7
- To reach my final goal, I have devised the following schedule of mini-goals.
 For each step in my program, I will give myself the reward listed.

I will begin to have ½ cup of fruit with breakfast	10/5	see movie
I will begin to have ½ cup of fruit with lunch	10/26	new video game
I will begin to substitute fruit juice for soda 1 time per day	11/16	concert

My overall reward for reaching my goal will be trip to beach
- I have gathered and analyzed data on my target behavior and have identified the following strategies for changing my behavior:
Keep the fridge stocked with easy-to-carry fruit. Pack fruit in my backpack every day. Buy lunch at place that serves fruit.
- I will use the following tools to monitor my progress toward my final goal:
Chart on fridge door
Diet log app

I sign this contract as an indication of my personal commitment to reach my goal: Tammy Lau 9/28

I have recruited a helper who will witness my contract and also increase his consumption of fruit; eat lunch with me twice a week.
Eric March 9/28

Figure 1.8 A sample behavior change contract

[Access the text alternative for slide images.](#)

Putting Your Plan into Action

This stage requires commitment—the resolve to stick with the plan no matter what temptations you encounter.

Use all your strategies to make your plan work.

Make sure your environment is change friendly, and get support and encouragement from others.

Most important, congratulate yourself.

Staying with It

Don't be surprised when you run into obstacles.

- Step back, see how you're doing, and feel free to make changes.

If your program is grinding to a halt, identify the problem—which may be among the following:

- Social influences.
- Levels of motivation and commitment.
- Choice of techniques and level of effort.
- Stress barrier.
- Procrastinating, rationalizing, and blaming.

Being Fit and Well for Life

Your first attempts at making behavior changes may never go beyond the contemplation or preparation stage.

Once you have started, don't stop.

Assume that health improvement is forever.

Take on the easier problems first, then use what you learn to tackle more difficult problems later.

When you feel challenged, remind yourself that you are creating a lifestyle that minimizes health risks and maximizes your enjoyment of life.

Test Your Knowledge

What lifestyle factor is the leading preventable cause of death for Americans?

Do the terms *health* and *wellness* mean the same thing?

Do people's genetic makeup determine whether they will develop certain diseases (such as breast cancer), regardless of their health habits?



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